

when you're stressed, and recognise how this results in sabotaging financial behaviour. It's often easier to recognise them when you list them so grab a piece of paper and write them down. Once you've recognised those times you do financially sabotage when stressed, you need to come up with an alternative strategy or alternative behaviours you might employ instead.

Finally, start to become a detective and recognise those inflection points or moments that cause you stress. Most of us don't need to look too far to find a point of stress—even if it's the recent global pandemic and our own reaction to that and its impact on our finances. But we're not looking here just at the global stressors; stress occurs often in the everyday moments. For example, it might be an angry co-worker, an overwhelmed customer, a sick parent, confrontation or dealing with trauma. It's often helpful if you keep a stress log or diary of your stressors so that you can start to recognise them when they turn up again and you can immediately implement your plan to deal with them.

This chapter is all about the 10 per cent of life when your general financial habits don't work for you. It's about making a plan now to mitigate the sabotaging effect of those times when you are stressed and ensuring you're acting in your best financial interests.

Again, this is about making the unconscious conscious so that you can direct your life and take control of your finances. By recognising stressors and your related sabotaging behaviours, you can start creating an environment and setting up great financial habits that work best for your unique Financial Phenotype—for the whole of your life.